origins to unite Indians of all faiths as a shared experience (the revelry of Holi, the celebratory gift-giving of Onam, and the lights, firecrackers, mithais and social gambling of Diwali, have made all three into 'secular' occasions). Festivals—utsavas, melas, leelas—all 'Hindu' in origin, have become occasions for the mingling of ordinary Indians of all backgrounds. Religion lies at the heart of Indian culture, but not necessarily as a source of division; religious myths like the *Ramayana* and the *Mahabharata* provide a common idiom, a shared matrix of reference, to all Indians, and it was not surprising that when Doordarshan broadcast a fifty-two-episode serialisation of the *Mahabharata*, the script was written by a Muslim, Dr Rahi Masoom Raza. Hinduism and Islam are intertwined in India; both religions, after all, have shared the same history in the same space, and theirs is a cohabitation of necessity as well as fact.

To some degree, India's other minorities have found it comfortable to take on elements of Hindu culture as proof of their own integration into the national mainstream. The tennis-playing brothers Anand, Vijay and Ashok Amritraj all bear Hindu names, but they are Christian, the sons of Robert and Maggie Amritraj, and they played with prominent crosses dangling from their necks, which they were fond of kissing in supplication or gratitude at tense moments on court. But giving their children Hindu names must have seemed, to Robert and Maggie, more nationalist in these post-colonial times, and quite unrelated to which god they were brought up to worship. I would not wish to make too much of this, because Muslim Indians still feel obliged to adopt Arab names in deference to the roots of their faith, but the Amritraj case (repeated in many other Christian families I know) is merely an example of Hinduism serving as a framework for the voluntary cultural assimilation of minority groups, without either compulsion or conversion becoming an issue. Keralites almost unanimously consider the Christian singer Yesudas (whose very name is derived from Jesus!) to be the greatest-ever singer of Malayalam devotional songs and bhajans; for decades his songs were played at and around the Guruvayur temple while, as a Christian, the singer himself was not allowed in. (In September 2017 it was,